

Ultimate Nutrition

Vitamin E

Vitamin E is any of several fat-soluble vitamins that are chemically tocopherols. Vitamin E is a popular and powerful antioxidant. Vitamin E is effective in preventing the oxidation of polyunsaturated fatty acids. Additionally, Vitamin E is helpful in the prevention of oxidation in the lungs, where strong oxidizing agents nitrogen dioxide and ozone, components of air pollution, are particularly harmful to people exercising. Vitamin E protects white and red blood cells, helping the body's immune system.

Antioxidants, such as Vitamin C and Vitamin E, are an important part of the body's defense against muscle damage from exercise. Strenuous exercise increases the body's production of free radicals, which, in turn, can cause muscle damage, which manifests as swollen or painful muscles. While exercise increases the body's natural defense against free radicals, athletes who are doing intense training may benefit from the addition of antioxidant supplements to their diets.

Cataracts are extremely common, and happen with most people as they age. A diet rich in antioxidants (Vitamin E and Vitamin C especially) may help prevent or delay the formation of cataracts, as oxidative damage appears to be a cause of their development.

Vitamin E has received important attention with the release of two important Harvard Medical School studies, which showed that the addition of 100IU or more of vitamin E per day resulted in a reduction by 40% of the risk of heart disease. In these studies, 125,000 health care professionals who did not have heart disease were followed for up to eight years. The addition of at least 400IU to 800IU per day has been shown to reduce the oxidation of blood lipids, which would otherwise result in the build-up known as atherosclerosis.

Vitamin E is also a powerful antioxidant whose antioxidant properties are enhanced by adding other antioxidants (selenium is a particularly good companion, as the combination produces glutathione peroxidase, an excellent antioxidant, protection from atherosclerosis and Alzheimer's disease.). This fact alone makes the addition of a Vitamin E supplement to your diet a good idea. If prevention of heart disease doesn't appeal to you, maybe this does: vitamin E deficiency can result in an increase of ceroid pigment deposits on the skin: age-spots.

A study (a randomized, placebo-controlled double-blind study) was published which suggested that a lack of Vitamin E was a more consistent predictor of heart disease than high cholesterol levels, with results that indicated low levels of Vitamin E to be predictive of heart attacks 62% of the time, while high cholesterol was predictive only 29% of the time.

Selected References:

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FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS:

1. What kind of tocopherol is in Ultimate Nutrition Vitamin E softgels?

Ultimate Nutrition's Natural Vitamin E Complex contains all four members (d-alpha, d-beta, d-delta, d-gamma tocopherol) of the tocopherol family of compounds, making it more nutritionally complete. This natural form of vitamin E is the most powerful and effective form of this antioxidant because it is the easiest form for your body to absorb.

2. In what foods can Vitamin E be naturally found?

Foods that contain a significant amount of vitamin E include: nuts (including almonds, hazelnuts, and walnuts) as well as sunflower seeds, corn-oil margarine, mayonnaise, cold-pressed vegetable oils, including corn, safflower, soybean, cottonseed, canola, and wheat germ (the richest one), spinach and kale, sweet potatoes, and yams.

3. Does the average diet supply optimal amounts of vitamin E?

Research suggests that considerably more vitamin E than is consumed in the average diet is necessary to prevent free radical cell damage that compromises health. In addition foods are depleted of vitamin E by processing, refining and storage. Also, today's diet conscious population tends to eliminate the salad dressings and oil rich foods that provide dietary vitamin E.